

Scaling new peaks

The latest headphone amplifier on the block

We know what you're thinking: "What use is a headphone amp to me? My phone and high-quality headphones are all that I need to enjoy my music." Allow us to tell you that you couldn't be further away from the true potential of your music player-headphone combo. The only thing that can bridge the enormous gap is a headphone amp. We exaggerate the difference in sound quality, because when you plonk the FiiO E11K or the 'Kilimanjaro2', you're probably going to be thinking, "I've never heard that before. Maybe I should listen to another track... and another track...and another..." and before you know it, you're dangerously dehydrated and have just spent several hours listening to your favourite songs like you're listening to them for the first time in your life.

The Kilimanjaro2, as the name suggests, is version 2.0 of FiiO's portable headphone amplifier. It's made of metal, has a 1400 mAh battery inside, a line-in, a headphone-out, a switch to toggle gain on/off, a dial to crank it up and a switch to either give you less bass or more bass.

It's rechargeable and will last upto 16 hours. A few hours with this gadget and you won't ever want to go back to being without it.



SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 91.2 x 56 x 13mm | **Battery:** 1400 mAh | **Operating time:** 16 hours | **Weight:** 92 grams | **Price:** \$60 (~₹3,700)

Scrambled on toast anyone?

Scramblers were once what motocross is today. Or to put it in a better sentence, a scrambler used to be a type of motorcycle used on off-road tracks. When Ducati introduced the Scrambler back in the 60s, it instantly became a legend. Now, over 50 years later, Ducati has brought it back and it still looks as gorgeous as it did back in the day. With the new Scrambler, Ducati hasn't tried recreating the older design. Instead, it has (or claims to have) evolved the bike into what it would have looked like today, had it not been shelved back in the 70s.

The 2015 Scrambler will be available here halfway through the year and in four variants: Icon, Classic, Full Throttle and Urban Enduro. Each has a few subtle changes in the way the bike is built and all four of them come with a slew of interchangeable parts that open up new vistas of customisation. It's powered by a 803cc L-Twin engine from the Monster 796, which sits neatly inside a new trellis frame. Power is sent to the rear wheel via a six-speed transmission and the bike gets a disc at each wheel, built by Brembo, to take care of the stopping.



The engine is said to have been de-tuned and isn't as high-strung as the Monster's – making it better suited for an urban commuter. Touted to be one of Ducati's cheaper options, the Scrambler can be soon expected to paint the town yellow.

SPECIFICATIONS

Price: ₹6-7 lakhs (expected) | **Engine:** 803cc L-Twin | **Power:** 75 bhp | **Top Speed:** 265 kmph, 0-100 kmph in 3.4 sec